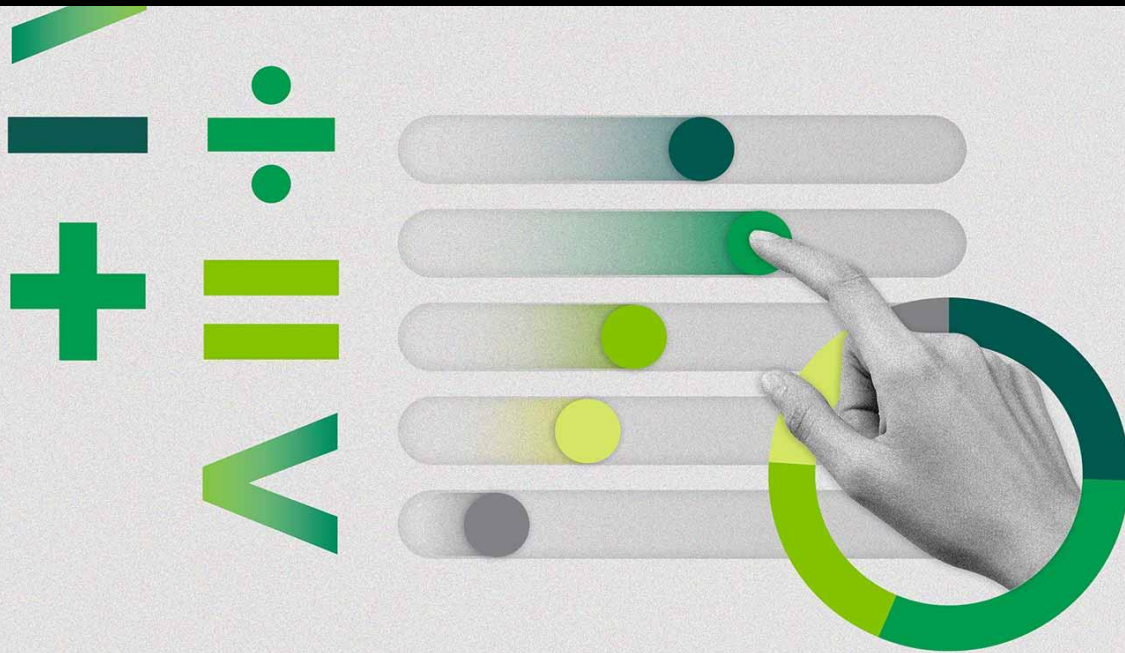


Chan Zuckerberg Initiative and Gallup

AI Tools in Education



A STRATEGIC RESEARCH
PROGRAM TO UNCOVER
BARRIERS AND DEMAND
FOR AI IN EDUCATION



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OVERVIEW

Gallup is pleased to submit this proposal to the Chan Zuckerberg Initiative (CZI) to develop a rigorous research program designed to map the real landscape of AI tool usage, demand, adoption and non-adoption across K–12 education. As AI tools rapidly enter classrooms, a gap has emerged between general opinions about AI and educators' real experiences using these tools, particularly when it comes to quality, reliability and instructional fit. This project is designed to address that gap.

This research will identify where real demand exists for high-quality, curriculum- and pedagogy-aligned AI tools, and where current offerings fall short. By separating philosophical resistance from practical barriers such as hallucinations, inaccuracies and misalignment with classroom practice, the study will clarify where improvements in tool quality would meaningfully expand use, particularly in literacy and math instruction.

Gallup brings unmatched experience in measuring complex, emerging technologies in education with methodological rigor and real-world relevance. This proposal builds directly on Gallup's recent work examining **AI in education** for the **Walton Family Foundation**, as well as Gallup's multi-audience **Math Matters initiative with the Gates Foundation**, which explored educator, parent and system-leader perspectives on instructional quality, materials alignment and implementation barriers at the national scale. Across these efforts, Gallup has integrated educator, parent and leader perspectives into a single, coherent evidence base that informs both product development and public discourse.

Equally important, Gallup operates with a communications-first research model that is uniquely suited to CZI's ambition to shape the broader education technology ecosystem. Gallup designs research with amplification in mind from the outset, engaging internal communications experts and, when appropriate, external journalists early in the survey design process to ensure findings are not only rigorous, but also compelling, accessible and newsworthy. This approach has repeatedly resulted in coverage in high-impact national and sector-specific outlets and positions this project for visibility in leading technology publications, such as TechCrunch, where developer audiences actively seek credible signals of market demand.

PROJECT APPROACH

Gallup will conduct a coordinated, multi-audience survey program encompassing the full ecosystem that shapes AI adoption in K–12 education:

- **K–12 teachers**, with subgroup analysis among math and reading/literacy teachers
- **School leaders**, including principals and superintendents
- **Parents of K–12 students**, with analysis among digital native parents

Survey Design

Gallup will begin the project by working closely with the CZI team to design a robust survey instrument that includes questions that can be deployed across all audiences, along with audience-specific modules for teachers, school leaders and parents. The team will seek continuity across the surveys so that attitudes on the same concepts can be contrasted across the populations studied, while also individualizing the items for each target population to ensure relevancy.

Gallup will start with a focused review of CZI's existing research, Gallup's prior work on AI in education. This review will identify what is already well understood and where developer-relevant demand signals remain underexplored.

Following the review of prior research, Gallup's team of survey methodologists, education subject-matter experts and communications leaders will develop a draft survey instrument. Gallup's communications-first approach ensures that the survey questions are framed to yield clear, interpretable findings that can be responsibly amplified to developer and media audiences. Where appropriate, Gallup can pressure-test draft constructs within its network of journalists to maximize later coverage and interest in the work.

The survey will be designed to explore a range of topic areas that may include, but are not limited to:

- **Demand for aligned, high-quality tools:** The extent to which educators and parents want AI tools grounded in academic materials, including curriculum alignment, and course material alignment.
- **Current usage and adoption patterns:** Which AI tools educators and parents report using today; how those tools are being used (e.g., instructional support, lesson planning, administrative tasks or evaluation); and where usage occurs.
- **Barriers to adoption and non-use:** Reasons educators and parents are not using AI tools, including philosophical or values-based concerns as well as practical constraints such as hallucinations, inaccurate information, lack of curriculum alignment, misalignment with pedagogy, insufficient trust or unclear academic value.
- **Latent and unmet demand:** Areas where educators and parents express interest in AI tools that do not currently meet their needs, including interest in tools aligned to curriculum, course materials, and everyday instructional practice.

Draft instruments will be provided to the CZI team for review and approval. The CZI team's feedback will be incorporated iteratively to ensure the surveys reflect CZI's overarching goals.

Once the survey draft is finalized, Gallup will begin the cognitive interview process to test the survey instrument. The purpose of the cognitive interviewing process is to ensure items are clear, easy to interpret and focused on eliciting the desired information from respondents. In the cognitive interview process, Gallup will ask participants to:

1. Discuss their interpretation of survey instructions, questions and response choices;
2. Discuss the process in which they would go about answering the questions; and
3. Provide any recommendations to clarify question wording for unclear or difficult-to-answer items.

The cognitive interview process will allow Gallup to evaluate respondent comprehension, item relevance to the sampled population, the extent to which it is feasible for respondents to answer a survey question, and the steps required to select a response. Gallup will provide any recommended changes that result from this process to the project team.

Sampling and Data Collection

Once survey development is complete, Gallup will field the study among parents of K–12 students, teachers, and education leaders, including principals and superintendents.

Parents of K–12 Students

Gallup will survey parents using its proprietary Gallup Panel. The Gallup Panel is a probability-based panel, which consists of approximately 100,000 U.S. adults. Gallup will aim for up to 2,500 completed parent interviews, which will support robust analysis by parent generation, including digitally native parents, and by openness to technology. Gallup will weight the general population sample at study conclusion to ensure the final sample is representative of all U.S. parents, including on the basis of race/ethnicity, gender, age, education level and geography.

K–12 Teachers

Gallup will survey teachers using the Gallup Panel. The teacher survey will focus on educators whose instructional responsibilities make AI tools most relevant, including teachers in grades 1–5 (excluding physical education and arts) and teachers in grades 6–12 who teach math and/or reading or literacy. Based on prior teacher studies and panel availability, Gallup estimates that approximately 600–700 completed teacher interviews are feasible and sufficient to support robust national reporting and selected subgroup analysis. Teacher data will be weighted to reflect the national teacher population across grade bands, subjects and key demographic characteristics

Education Leaders

Gallup will survey school and district leaders, including principals, and superintendents. This sample will be drawn from high-quality national education leader lists and is expected to yield approximately 1,000

completed interviews. The sample achieved may support analysis by district size, geography and other contextual characteristics relevant to AI implementation decisions.

Analysis

Gallup will begin the Analysis phase by proposing an analysis plan based on its understanding of CZI's objectives. This analysis will include a range of statistical techniques including crosstabulations, descriptive statistics and regression modeling. The analysis plan will include a series of techniques that will ultimately highlight the similarities and differences in how teachers, parents and education leaders view AI in education. Gallup will examine how each audiences' perspectives align or conflict. Where sample sizes allow, Gallup will examine differences across key groups, such as grade level, subject area, leadership role and parent generation. Focused attention will be given to literacy and math contexts.

Reporting and Amplification

Gallup researchers will work with the CZI team to identify the most important findings resulting from the research. Gallup will prepare publicly released reports and articles inclusive of key quantitative findings, narrative supporting these insights and related graphics.

Gallup recommends releasing two distinct reports (approximately ten pages each) that will focus on related topics but will be released separately to extend the media conversation.

Each report will be accompanied by a News.Gallup.com article, which are short, 500- to 750-word pieces that highlight a limited set of findings and encourage readers to learn more by reading the full report. As a Google News-registered provider, www.news.Gallup.com has a global reach, regularly achieving over 140,000 new media mentions in over 100 countries annually. Gallup.com averages 1.5-2 million visits per month.

Gallup's communications team will partner closely with the CZI team develop a communications plan that leverages multiple release dates of articles and accompanying reports to extend the media conversation. Gallup's communications team will develop a target publications and journalist list and share with the CZI team prior to media pitching.

Gallup will also amplify the most compelling of findings its social media platforms, which are actively followed by journalists, policymakers, influencers, and the public. Gallup leverages its various social media platforms, including Gallup LinkedIn, GallupNews and @Gallup handles via X, cross-collaborating with client accounts. If desired by CZI, Gallup may feature the data in a Gallup Podcast episode at a mutually agreed upon time.

Gallup will share content, including reports, news coverage and crosstabulations, via a research hub on Gallup's website. Gallup will also prepare an annual report documenting media coverage and total reach so the CZI team can continuously monitor progress and impact.

Launch Event at Gallup World HQ

To officially publicly release the findings, Gallup will organize a public launch event to scale research to new audiences and deepen relationships with key developer groups and stakeholders.

In previous partnerships, Gallup has hosted meaningful conversations at its Washington, D.C., headquarters with notable leaders such as Newt Gingrich, Hillary Clinton, Sir Jeremy Farrar, Chuck Hagel, Bill Gates, university presidents as well as with noted politicians, philanthropists, academics and social change leaders.

Gallup will work collaboratively with CZI to develop a curated invite list of speakers and attendees, aiming to convene thought leaders, developers, influencers, media, and storytellers to engage with the further the national conversation around AI in education. The launch event will include an opening networking session with light food and refreshments, a keynote speech and data presentation of the key findings from the research, and conclude with a panel discussion featuring prominent influencers and experts to discuss the impact of the results, including an audience Q&A.

INVESTMENT

All pricing includes project management, annual data collection and weighting, analysis and reporting, communications support, and Gallup.com amplification.

Core Research Program \$534,200

Includes:

- parent survey (n=2,500)
- teacher survey (n=700)
- education leader survey (n=1,000)
- two public-facing reports (10 pages each)
- two Gallup.com articles
- media pitching
- crosstabs, topline and internal briefing deck

Additional Amplification Support \$110,500

Includes everything in the Core Research Program, plus

- Gallup World HQ launch event
- Social media content for Gallup official social channels
- Inclusion of data in Gallup Podcast
- Additional Gallup.com Article

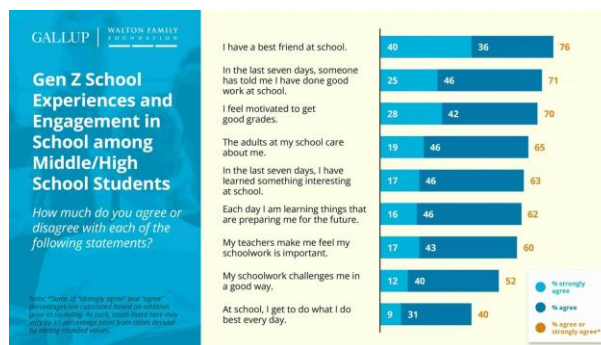
PAST PERFORMANCE

Gallup has surveyed millions of parents youth nationally through the Gallup Student Poll and its partnerships with leading organizations, foundations, higher education institutions and school districts. Gallup has conducted studies for **Google**, **Amazon**, **Apple**, the **Barr Foundation** and **Lumina Foundation**, among others. Gallup's research to date has spanned a variety of important topics facing leaders as they work to understand youth needs, perspectives and barriers to opportunity, including access to computer science education, the quality of the parent-student relationship, the impact of social media on adolescent health and wellbeing, how positive parent relationships can positively mitigate negative youth experiences, challenges to remaining enrolled in higher education, learning loss, learning experiences, hope, voting behavior and civic engagement, wellbeing, entrepreneurship, and their aspirations for their future.

Walton Family Foundation-Gallup Gen Z Research and Teacher Insights

In 2023, the Walton Family Foundation (WFF) launched a multiyear partnership with Gallup to uncover the experiences, attitudes and aspirations of Gen Z on a range of issues related to education, wellbeing and the workforce. In partnership with WFF, Gallup developed the first nationally representative panel of Gen Z youth in the U.S. to obtain novel insights from youth and the parents of youth under the age of 18.

WFF leverages the panels to conduct four surveys of 2,000-3,000 respondents each, annually. Three of these surveys are shorter “pulse” surveys that allow the WFF-Gallup teams to quickly collect information from Gen Z panelists about pressing, newsworthy issues. For each of the surveys, Gallup is responsible for survey design, cognitive testing, programming, data collection, analysis, reporting and communications activities. To date, the surveys have explored Gen Z's purpose and preparedness for their future, interest in postsecondary pathways, perceptions of and interest in STEM careers, trust in U.S. institutions, beliefs and behaviors related to social media, happiness, and wellbeing, among other topics.



To disseminate critical findings from these reports to education leaders, academics, policymakers and the media, Gallup developed a robust communication strategy, leveraging media pitching, podcasts, social media campaigns and stakeholder convenings. Gallup has also released a series of articles on its proprietary news platform, news.gallup.com, detailing the findings from this research, including the **persistence of the gender gap in STEM among youth**, **Gen Z's low trust in major institutions**, and the **high rates of anxiety and stress among LGB Gen Z members**.

The research has received widespread media coverage, including via Axios, **CNN**, the **CNBC Squawk Box**, **The Hill**, **USA Today** and **Fortune**, as well as many local news affiliates. Gallup's findings were also reported on across education media platforms, such as **EducationWeek**, and **The 74**. These collective efforts have helped build the WFF brand as the definite voice on all things Gen Z.

In addition to its Gen Z research, the Walton Family Foundation has partnered with Gallup on an ongoing, multiyear effort, *Teaching for Tomorrow*, to deepen understanding of the experiences, engagement and professional wellbeing of K-12 teachers across the United States. Through nationally representative surveys of K-12 public school teachers, this research generates actionable insights on teacher engagement and wellbeing, conditions that support effective teaching, and the supports teachers say they need to be successful and stay in the profession. To date, the research has examined key aspects of the teacher experience, including job satisfaction and burnout, access to high-quality instructional materials and professional learning, perceptions of student preparedness for college and career, and how AI can help in teachers' daily work to maximize instructional time.

Gallup is responsible for survey design, overseeing data collection, analysis, reporting and communications activities for this work. To disseminate critical findings to education leaders, policymakers and the media,

Gallup has supported a robust communications strategy that includes reports, articles, media pitching and stakeholder convenings. Findings from *Teaching for Tomorrow* have been featured in national and education-focused media outlets and elevated through high-profile forums, including the Aspen Ideas Festival, where Gallup and WFF research on the “AI dividend” highlighted how teachers are using AI tools to reclaim time and reduce administrative burden, helping advance broader conversations about innovation, educator support and the future of teaching.

Lumina Foundation-Gallup State of Higher Education Study

In 2020, Gallup began partnering with Lumina Foundation to examine the state of the student experience and the national challenges facing higher education during and following the pandemic and amidst declining enrollments nationally. Since then, Gallup has conducted the study again in 2021, 2022 and recently in the fall of 2023, building upon insights gathered in each annual survey administration and uncovering new and evergreen issues facing the higher education industry. In the 2023 administration, Gallup retained key metrics included in the 2020-2022 study administrations, such as challenges to remaining enrolled and the reasons students were able to remain enrolled. Gallup also introduced new concepts to better understand belonging and mental health and wellbeing challenges currently enrolled and prospective students face, impacting their desire to enroll and remain enrolled.

Gallup is responsible for the survey design, data collection, analysis, reporting and communications activities surrounding this research. In each of these distinct studies, Gallup has used a web-based survey to interview currently enrolled college students pursuing a two- or four-year degree, currently enrolled students pursuing a certificate or certification program, individuals who have some college experience but have stopped out, and Americans who have never enrolled before in education and training beyond high school. To date, topics explored in this study have included student engagement in coursework, ease in accessing faculty and staff outside of scheduled class time, student wellbeing, and issues of diversity, equity and inclusion, as well as questions about satisfaction, likelihood to remain enrolled, potential barriers to continued enrollment, factors critical to retaining students, and perceptions of higher education in general in the areas of accessibility, affordability and quality.



The [2020](#), [2021](#), [2022](#) and forthcoming 2023 reports continue to further important conversations about the role of higher education, its performance for students from all backgrounds — including historically marginalized students — and its perceived utility in the market. Gallup has also released a series of articles detailing the findings from this research, including unique [challenges facing Hispanic college students](#), [students continuing to weigh college costs and career goals](#), [attitudes toward accessibility and affordability](#) of higher education, and how academic challenges and [mental health stress are increasingly forcing many students to consider unenrolling from their programs](#). The research received widespread media coverage, including via [Axios](#), [BET](#), [CNN](#), [Forbes](#), [The Wall Street Journal](#), [MarketWatch](#), [PBS NewsHour](#), [CNBC Online](#), [Diverse: Issues in Higher Education](#), [Inside Higher Ed](#), and Arizona State University’s [ASU Insight](#) online, among others.